

- ▶ **Windows Live:** This account type can be configured as your primary account (email, contacts, calendar, photos, feeds, and more) or as a secondary, normal account with email, contacts, and/or calendar sync. You must have at least one Windows Live account, which functions as your primary account. But you can configure multiple other Windows Live accounts as well.
- ▶ **Outlook:** Designed for Exchange-type servers, this account type works with email, contacts, and/or calendar data. But it's not just for Exchange. In fact, the Outlook account type will work with any account that uses EAS on the back end. And that's a surprising number of services, including Gmail/Google Calendar, Microsoft's Hotmail, and many others.
- ▶ **Yahoo! Mail:** This account type is for email only and uses the IMAP prototype to synchronize the view on your phone with your server-based email. IMAP is superior to the older POP3-style email accounts that were common a decade ago, but unlike EAS, it works only with email.
- ▶ **Google:** Microsoft explicitly supports Google's Gmail (for email and contacts) and Google Calendar because the services are so popular, but it's not much harder to configure this account type using the Outlook option. Behind the scenes, the accounts are configured the same way, using EAS.
- ▶ **Other account or advanced setup:** If the email account you're using doesn't fall neatly into one of the above categories, you can use one of these options to configure the account on Windows Phone. Both work similarly, are designed explicitly for email only (no contacts or calendar), and will work with virtually any email account there is, regardless of the required access protocol (POP3, IMAP, or whatever).

Okay, so here's a recap. You must have a primary (Windows Live based) account, and you may have any number of other accounts, including multiple accounts of the same type. Depending on the type, these accounts will provide access to different services, including email, contacts, and calendar.

With contacts and calendar services, Windows Phone provides a single, integrated experience that lets you view the content from multiple services in a single place. With contacts, that place is the People hub. With calendars,